OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course systematically introduces OpenClaw's model selection mechanism and three model switching methods.

2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

2.1 Open TUI Session

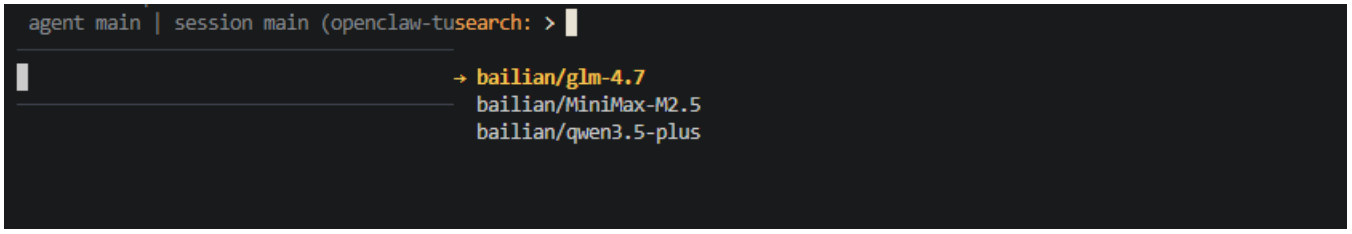
- Enter in the terminal

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
`/model`	View available model list, select and switch model

- Enter `/model` in the chat box and press Enter. For example, here we select and switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use the up and down arrow keys to select a model, then press Enter.



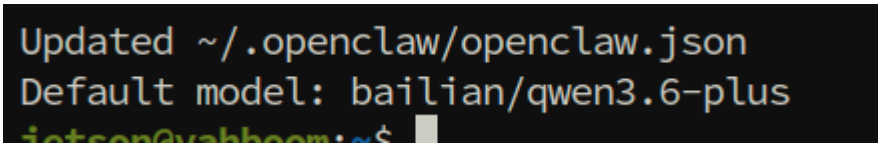
3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use a CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here we use switching to the `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```



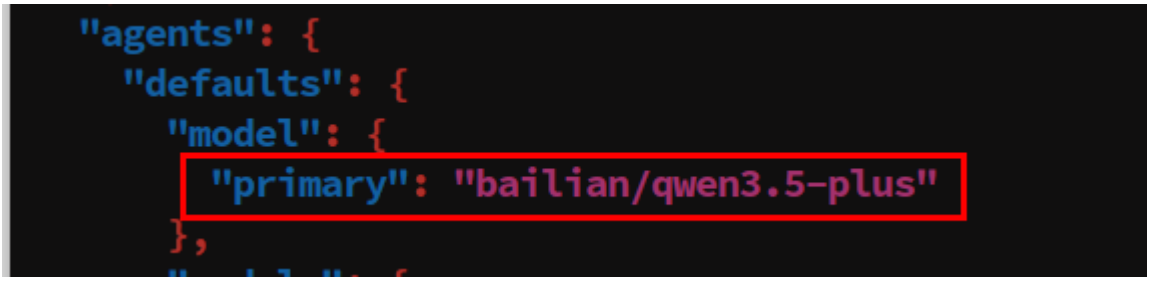
3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

  ```
  nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
  # Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc.
  ```

In `openclaw.json`, use the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item to specify the default primary model:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```



- Verify that the configuration has taken effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Config         : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir      : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default        : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model    : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)    : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allowlist/catalog** in OpenClaw that controls the range of available models. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list. This list simultaneously serves as the model range control basis for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` and add the models you need to use to the allowlist:

```
"agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "imageModel": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "openrouter/auto": {
          "alias": "OpenRouter"
        },
        "openrouter/openrouter/free": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
        "codingplan/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "codingplan/glm-5": {},
        "codingplan/glm-4.7": {},
        "codingplan/kimi-k2.5": {},
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {}
      },
      "workspace": "/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace",
      "compaction": {
        "mode": "safeguard"
      },
      "maxConcurrent": 4,
      "subagents": {
        "maxConcurrent": 8
```

```
      }
    }
  },
```



```
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "imageModel": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "openrouter/auto": {
          "alias": "OpenRouter"
        },
        "openrouter/openrouter/free": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "codingplan/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
        "codingplan/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "codingplan/glm-5": {},
        "codingplan/glm-4.7": {},
        "codingplan/kimi-k2.5": {},
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {}
      },
      "workspace": "/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace",
      "compaction": {
        "mode": "safeguard"
      },
      "maxConcurrent": 4,
      "subagents": {
        "maxConcurrent": 8
      }
    }
  },
```

4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/modelID
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
`anthropic/claude-opus-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
`anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
`openai/gpt-5.4`	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
`openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`	Model ID containing a slash

> **Note**: If the model ID itself contains `/` (e.g., `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the full reference in the format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
`openclaw onboard`	Beginner guide, helps quickly complete initial configuration
`openclaw models list`	View all configured models
`openclaw models status`	View current model configuration details
`/model`	View available model list in chat
`/model status`	View current model status details in chat